

ROLEPLAYER CARD NO. 1

MEDICINE

SETTING

Operating Theatre Suite

PATIENT

You are 45 years old. You are waiting for a day procedure to have a large lump removed from your back. The lump is about 10cm in diameter and you find it unsightly. You are also concerned that it may be cancerous. Your GP has assured you that it is a benign lipoma, not a cancer, but you remain unconvinced. The surgeon has already seen you to confirm your consent for the procedure but you have some further questions. You have asked for a doctor to talk to you.

TASK

- Explain your worry that the lump is cancerous. Ask how the surgeon will know whether it is or not.
- You have been told to come back to the outpatient clinic in two weeks. Find out why it takes so long for the results. Will you learn for certain then if the lump was cancerous?
- Express concern about the possibility of a scar on your back. What can you do to minimise this?
- Ask about the chance of the lump returning or a similar lump growing elsewhere on your body. What if the surgeon doesn't remove it all? You are very anxious.

CANDIDATE CARD NO. 1

MEDICINE

SETTING

Operating Theatre Suite

DOCTOR

You are working as a surgical resident in this hospital. You have been called to talk to a 45-year-old patient who is awaiting surgery for a large benign lipoma on his/her back. You note that the patient has already been booked into the outpatient clinic in two weeks for review of the wound and histopathology.

TASK

- Reassure the patient that the risk of cancer is extremely low.
- Explain that the lump will be examined under the microscope and the patient will normally get the results at the two-week review in the clinic. The wound will also be checked then.
- Explain that there will be a scar as it is a large lesion but it will fade with time. Keeping the area dressed with steristrips for a month can help to minimise this. The surgeon will discuss this further with the patient.
- Reassure the patient about removal of the lump and the unlikelihood of recurrence.